Linköping University
Institute for Analytical Sociology

Master's Thesis

Title

Descriptive Subtitle

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Contents

2 Introduction 1
3 Literature Review 2
4 Data and Methods 3
5 Results 4
6 Discussion 5
7 Conclusion 6
Appendix A: Additional Tables and Figures 7
Appendix B: Code 8
Appendix C: Prompts 9
Bibliography 10

List of Figures

Figure 1: Outsect 1

List of Tables

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics of Key Variables 3

Abstract

The bachelor thesis examines the change in positive framing in sociological publications against the background of academic capitalism. Based on the theory of increasing self-promotion, it is analyzed whether this is reflected in scientific abstracts through increasingly positive language. The paper conducts a sentiment analysis of 121,789 English-language abstracts of sociological articles from the Web of Science database (1993-2023) with two dictionaries for additional validity. Interval plots, linear regressions and Monte Carlo simulations are used to examine temporal trends in positive and negative sentiment. The results show a very small, statistically insignificant increase in positive sentiment over time, while no clear trend can be identified for negative sentiment. The work reveals methodological challenges in the sentiment analysis of scientific texts, particularly with regard to data distribution and the significance interpretation of large samples. Contrary to the results of previous research, the study provides no evidence for a substantial increase in positive framing.

1 Acknowledgements

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to my supervisors, Prof. Dr. Elmar Schlüter and Tim Schmidt, for their invaluable guidance and support throughout this research project. Their insights and feedback have been instrumental in shaping this work.

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Finally, I would like to thank my family and friends for their unwavering support and encouragement during the completion of this thesis.

1.1 Generative AI Statement

This thesis was written with assistance from generative AI tools for specific purposes including literature research, text editing, and formatting. All substantive content, analysis, and conclusions are the result of my own intellectual work. AI-generated suggestions were critically evaluated and modified as appropriate. Complete transparency regarding AI usage has been maintained throughout the research process.

1.2 Ethics Statement

This research was conducted in accordance with the ethical guidelines of Justus Liebig University Giessen and the German Sociological Association. All data used in this study consists of publicly available academic publications. No human subjects were involved in this research, and therefore no ethics approval was required. The analysis was conducted with integrity, transparency, and respect for intellectual property rights.

2 Introduction

Figure 1: Outsect

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3 Literature Review

4 Data and Methods

Variable	Mean	SD	N
Age	34.5	12.3	1,234
Income	45,000	15,000	1,234

Table 1: Descriptive Statistics of Key Variables

5 Results

6 Discussion

7 Conclusion

7 Appendix A: Additional Tables and Figures

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7 Appendix B: Code

```python
# Example: Data cleaning code
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np

# Load data
df = pd.read_csv('data.csv')

# Data processing steps
# ...
```

7 Appendix C: Prompts

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7 Bibliography